



Leading with Passion

BY ANN TROPEA, EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

I'll be honest. Before I joined the Navy League of the United States, I didn't spend a lot of time thinking about the United States Coast Guard. I had a vague idea of at-sea rescues for out-of-their-element mariners, and limited types of domestic disaster response, policing, and support.

I couldn't have been more off the mark.

The Coast Guard has 11 separate missions (page 38) and, because the organization falls under the authority of the Department of Homeland Security (and not Department of Defense), this gives the USCG the unique ability to enforce domestic maritime laws upon U.S. citizens. With the increasing prevalence of USCG shiprider agreements (page 35), this enforcement ability extends to international waters and helps strengthen diplomatic relationships with other countries.

From climate change affecting the already-challenging Arctic environment (page 28) to the evolving mission in Guam and the Indo-Pacific (page 32), the U.S. Coast Guard is literally everything, everywhere, all at once. It's impressive, to say the least.

I also had the honor of interviewing Admiral Linda L. Fagan, 27th Commandant of the Coast Guard for this issue (page 19) and learned a heck of a lot about the service she leads with a passion and dedication that is infectious. From recruiting challenges to women leadership to the recent Titan submersible disaster, we covered the literal waterfront. I (almost!) regretted my Marine Corps enlistment all those years ago, and had I realized the breadth and complexity of the Coast Guard's work — and incredible culture of mission and purpose — I could have been writing this editorial as a USCG veteran.

Finally, I would also like to recognize the leadership here at the Navy League of the United States. Christopher "Towny" Townsend was sworn in as our 52nd National President at our National Convention in June (page 11), and we couldn't be more excited to implement his bold agenda (page 1). Lastly, we remember a former, beloved editor-in-chief of Seapower (page 26) who led this publication with editorial skill, humor, and kindness.

I am humbled and can only strive to lead with the grace and passion of those who fill these pages.

Ready to lead, ready to follow.